

Event day runbook

What to do when something goes wrong, decided in advance rather than in front of a queue.

The one rule: taking photos and handing them out are separate

If guests cannot download their photos, **keep shooting**. Every finished session is already saved on the laptop and can be sent afterwards.

Delivery problems are the most likely thing to go wrong and the least damaging. **Never stop the booth to fix one.** Take names on paper and carry on — the photos are not at risk.

Sixty-second triage

Almost everything is downstream of these four. Check them in order.

1. **Is the app running?** The black console window should still be open. If not, run **Photobooth.Server.exe** again.
2. **Does the console load?** **http://localhost:5000/operator** on the laptop. If not, the app is not running — see 1.
3. **Is the camera ready?** The rail should say **Camera Ready**. Anything else is a camera or cable problem, not an app problem.
4. **Is the router powered?** Lights on. This one only affects delivery, never capture.

Before doors open

Thirty minutes. Prevents most of what follows.

- ☐ Router powered, **WAN port empty**, laptop cabled into a LAN port.
- ☐ **Start the booth after the cable is in.** The HTTPS certificate only covers addresses the laptop had at startup — joining a network afterwards means the iPad will refuse to connect.
- ☐ **Settings › Guests reach the booth at** — pick the **Ethernet** address, the one on the router's range.
- ☐ **Settings › wifi network and password** match the router exactly, including capitals.
- ☐ Output folder set, and **/diagnostics** shows plenty of free disk. Budget about **25 MB per session**.
- ☐ Camera: dummy battery in, manual exposure and white balance, fixed ISO, **JPEG only**, auto power-off disabled.
- ☐ Fire the remote once and confirm a photo lands in the watch folder.
- ☐ Run one full session end to end with the real camera.
- ☐ From your own phone: join the wifi, scan both codes, download a photo **and** the zip, and open them.
- ☐ iPad: display loads, mirror shows your face, **Auto-Lock Never**, Guided Access on, and **plugged in**.
- ☐ Write the booth's details into the box on the last page.

Power

What you see	What to do
Router has no lights	Check the socket and both ends of the barrel plug; try another socket. If it is dead: switch to the laptop's Mobile Hotspot, then in Settings pick the 192.168.137 address. Restart the booth afterwards. Expect a limit of 8 phones at once and no way to disconnect anyone.
Laptop switched to battery	Find a socket. Capture continues on battery for an hour or two — drop the screen brightness and carry on. Nothing is lost if it does die, but the session in progress is.
Camera dead	Check the dummy battery lead at both ends first; it pulls out easily. A real battery gets you under an hour as a stopgap.
Whole circuit tripped	Restart in order: router first , wait for its lights, then the laptop, then the booth app. Starting the app before the network is up is what breaks the iPad.

Camera and capture

The half that actually matters. Protect this.

What you see	What to do
Pressing the remote does nothing	Press the camera's own shutter . If that produces a photo, the remote is at fault — replace its battery or re-pair it, and shoot from the camera meanwhile. If neither works, it is the USB cable or EOS Utility.
"No photo arrived" / the session times out	Usually the camera has gone to sleep, the USB has been knocked, or EOS Utility has closed. Wake the camera and check EOS Utility is still in remote shooting mode. Press Abort and start the guest again.
Photos are not being picked up	The watch folder is wrong. Settings > Watch folder must be where EOS Utility actually saves. /diagnostics lists the files it can see — if that list is empty, the folder is wrong.
Photos appear but are ignored	The camera is shooting RAW. Set it to JPEG only ; RAW files are skipped deliberately.
Camera card full	Set the camera to save to the computer only, or swap the card.

The app

What you see	What to do
A session is stuck	Press Abort . That returns it to Idle and clears the guest's photos and link. Start the next guest normally.
The app crashed / console window gone	Run Photobooth.Server.exe again. Every finished session is already on disk and safe — only the one in progress is lost. Re-shoot that guest.
The console page will not load	The app is not running. Restart it. If it will not start, check the disk is not full.
Disk nearly full	About 25 MB per session. Copy older session folders to a USB drive and delete them from the output folder — but not ones whose guests have not downloaded yet, or their link stops working.
The strip looks wrong	Check Templates . Avoid changing the layout mid-event; it affects every session after it, not the ones already taken.

Guest photo delivery

The most likely thing to fail, and the least serious. See the rule on page 1.

What you see	What to do
Guests cannot find the wifi network	The name in Settings is only text for the QR code — it does not create anything. Check the router is broadcasting that exact name, capitals included.
Phone joins, but the photos page never loads	First: Settings > <i>Guests reach the booth at</i> — is it the router's address? Second: the router's guest-network or client-isolation setting must be off . Those two cover almost every case.
Settings warns it is "guessing"	The laptop is on more than one network. Pick the address on the guests' network. Takes effect immediately, no restart.
Settings names an address it cannot find	Saved at a different venue. Pick again from the list.
"We cannot find those photos"	The link is mistyped, or that session's folder has been deleted or moved out of the output folder.
An Android guest loses the page	Their phone switched itself back to mobile data because our network has no internet. Ask them to rejoin and stay connected. Put this on the sign.
Phones complain there is no internet	Expected and correct. The photos page still works.
Delivery is broken and you cannot fix it	Stop troubleshooting. Take names and emails on paper, keep shooting, and send the photos afterwards from the output folder. The event is not damaged by this.

The iPad display

What you see	What to do
Stuck on "Connecting..."	Check the iPad is on the same network as the laptop — not the venue wifi, not mobile data. If it is, restart the booth app. <i>On v0.12.1 and older this was a bug with no workaround; upgrade.</i>
Safari says the connection is not private	Certificate Trust Settings > switch the booth on. If it started after a network change, restart the booth — the certificate only covers addresses present when the app started.
The iPad screen keeps sleeping	Auto-Lock > Never , and keep it on a charger.
Page loads but there is no mirror	Settings > Apps > Safari > Camera > Allow , then reload. If the address starts http:// rather than https , no permission will help.
It shows the rear camera	Reload the page.
The iPad is dead or unusable	Plug a monitor into the laptop and open http://localhost:5000/display . A complete fallback that needs no network at all. This is the one worth rehearsing.

Guests and the queue

What you see	What to do
A guest left without downloading	Take their name and email. Their folder is on the laptop and you can send it afterwards.
The queue is building	Reduce the photo count for a session, or move guests through review faster. Do not change the template.
A guest cannot manage the QR	Offer to scan it on your own phone and show them, or just take their email.
A guest wants their photos removed	Delete that session's folder from the output folder after the event. Their link dies with it.

If the laptop dies completely

This is the only failure that stops the event, because the laptop is the booth: it watches for photos, builds the strips, stores the sessions and serves the gallery.

1. **The photos already taken are not lost.** They are on that laptop's disk and on the camera's card if it is set to save both.
2. **Keep shooting on the camera alone.** Set it to save to its card, and photograph guests normally. No strips and no instant delivery, but the event still has photos.
3. **Take names and emails.** Compose and send afterwards.
4. Tell guests plainly that photos will follow by email. People mind far less than you would expect when told.

Worth doing at the start of the night

Set the camera to save to **both** the card and the computer, if it offers it. It costs nothing and turns a dead laptop from a disaster into an inconvenience.

After the event

- ☐ **Copy the whole output folder somewhere else before anything else.** One copy is not a backup.
- ☐ Send photos to anyone who asked, and to anyone whose session you know failed to deliver.
- ☐ Delete any session a guest asked you to remove.
- ☐ Write down anything that went wrong while it is fresh — that is what improves the next one.

Spares kit

- ☐ Spare battery for the remote (CR2032 for the BR-E1)
- ☐ Spare USB-C cable, and a spare ethernet cable
- ☐ Extension lead and a multi-way adaptor
- ☐ USB drive, for offloading sessions if the disk fills
- ☐ Power bank, if the router is USB-powered
- ☐ **Paper and a pen** — the fallback for every delivery failure
- ☐ This runbook, printed

Fill this in before doors open

So anyone standing at the booth can answer a question without you.

Wifi network name

Wifi password

Booth address (from Settings)

Output folder

App version

Who to call
